LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses across logistics, e-commerce and payments. Experienced with Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Spark, Kafka, Snowflake, Redshift and AWS. Proven record improving pipeline reliability and performance, establishing data contracts and quality checks, and building reusable data tools for multiple teams. MSc in Computer Science; professional English (C1).

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data platforms and engineering: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations
Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions
Data modeling and BI: Dimensional modeling, star schemas, Power BI, Looker (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | *Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka* 03/2022 – Present

- Own the ingestion layer of the data platform, operating approximately 140 Airflow DAGs that load data from PostgreSQL, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt, delivering 420+ models with tests on every model and reducing nightly runtime from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes.
- Introduced JSON Schema data contracts between product teams and data engineering, enforced through CI checks; reduced broken-pipeline incidents from approximately 9 to 2 per month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming to process approximately 30 million shipment-tracking events per day.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers and lead weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | *Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb* 09/2019 – 02/2022

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR for transaction reconciliation, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files from S3 daily.
- Designed a Redshift warehouse schema with 30+ fact and dimension tables, used by finance and risk teams.
- Implemented Great Expectations data quality checks for critical finance tables.
- Developed an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Catalog access, adopted by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer | *Adria Retail Group, Split* 06/2017 – 08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL pipelines for an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports supporting store operations across 40+ stores.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) | Northgate Technical University, 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) | English (C1) | German (B1)